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Handgun compensator

Abstract

A recoil compensator for a handgun defines a through opening along a central axis, the through opening including a threaded portion configured to threadably engage the threads on the distal end portion of the barrel. The recoil compensator further defines a port in a top wall and defines fastener openings each configured to receive a taper pin. When the recoil compensator is installed on the barrel, the central axis is substantially coincident with the bore axis and the port is configured to vent a portion of propellant gases from the barrel upon firing the handgun. The threaded portion threadably engages the threads on the barrel with a distal end of the barrel positioned proximally of the port. Each taper pin is received in a respective fastener opening and engages a side of the barrel. A slide assembly and handgun including the compensator are also disclosed.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit under 35 U.S.C. § 119(e) of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/369,794 titled HANDGUN COMPENSATOR, and filed on Jul. 29, 2022, the contents of which are incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to handguns and more specifically to a compensator attachment for a handgun.

BACKGROUND

(2) A muzzle brake or recoil compensator is a type of muzzle device for a firearm that is designed to reduce muzzle rise or “muzzle flip” by redirecting a portion of propellant gases leaving the barrel. Some compensators can be attached to the barrel, such as threading the device onto a handgun barrel or rifle barrel. Other compensators are integral to the barrel, such as when the barrel defines ports along the length of the barrel to vent gases. Whether using an attachment or ports in the barrel, the burst of propellant gases is directed upward to counter recoil forces that tend to make the muzzle rise upon shooting the firearm. A recoil compensator or simply “compensator” may be used on a handgun with the advantage of enabling the shooter to more quickly realign sights on a target for the next shot.

SUMMARY

(3) One aspect of the present disclosure is directed to a compensator attachment for a handgun barrel. In one example, the compensator can be secured to the distal end of the barrel using fasteners, such as taper pins or cam pins, installed through the compensator after threading the compensator onto the barrel. Also disclosed is a slide assembly including the compensator as well as a firearm including the compensator or slide assembly.

(4) The features and advantages described herein are not all-inclusive and, in particular, many additional features and advantages will be apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art in view of the drawings, specification, and claims. Moreover, it should be noted that the language used in the specification has been selected principally for readability and instructional purposes and not to limit the scope of the disclosed subject matter.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates a front and top perspective view of a compensator for a handgun, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is a front view of the compensator of FIG. 1.

(3) FIG. 3 is a side view of the compensator of FIG. 1.

(4) FIG. 4 is a front perspective view showing a longitudinal section of the compensator of FIG. 1.

- (5) FIG. 5 is a top and rear perspective view showing part of a handgun slide and a compensator in a disassembled form, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a front perspective view of a distal end portion of a handgun slide with a compensator attached to the barrel, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of a fastener that can be used to secure a compensator to a handgun barrel, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 8 is a cross-sectional view of a fastener that can be used to secure a compensator to a handgun barrel, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a top perspective view of a distal end portion of a handgun slide with a compensator attached to the barrel, where the compensator is illustrated as transparent to better show the barrel and fasteners, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 10 is a top view of a distal end portion of a handgun slide with a compensator attached to the barrel, where the compensator is illustrated as transparent to better show the barrel and fasteners, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (11) FIG. 11 is a front perspective view of a slide assembly that includes a compensator, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (12) FIG. 12 is an exploded, side and rear perspective view showing components of a slide assembly, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 13A illustrates a top and rear perspective view of a compensator installed on a barrel with fasteners in an unlocked position, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 13B illustrates a top and rear perspective view of the compensator of FIG. 13A with the fasteners 176 rotated to a locked position, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (15) FIG. 13C illustrates a top and partial cross-sectional view of the compensator of FIG. 13A and shows the fasteners in an unlocked position and not engaging the barrel, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (16) FIG. 13D illustrates a top and partial cross-sectional view of the compensator of FIG. 13B and shows the fasteners in a locked position and engaging the barrel, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (17) FIG. 14 illustrates steps in a method of installing a compensator on a handgun barrel, in accordance with some embodiments.
- (18) The figures depict various embodiments of the present disclosure for purposes of illustration only. Numerous variations, configurations, and other embodiments will be apparent from the following detailed discussion.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (19) Disclosed is a compensator for a semiautomatic handgun. In one example, the compensator is configured to attach to the distal end portion of a barrel and can be secured using fasteners. For example, the compensator can threadably engage a threaded portion of the barrel or can use a slip fit over a threaded or non-threaded end portion of a barrel. The compensator can be secured to the barrel using one or more taper pins or threaded pins that extend through the compensator and engage the barrel, such as a flat or recess in the sides of the barrel. The use of taper pins or similar fastener provide a mechanical stop that prevents rotation of the compensator after the compensator is threaded onto the barrel.
- (20) In one embodiment, the compensator extends beyond the end of the barrel and has one or more ports positioned to direct a portion of propellant gases upward through the port(s) to counter act recoil forces that typically cause muzzle rise. For example, a port in the upper wall of the compensator directs gases upward and forward. The port is positioned distally of the distal end of the barrel. In other embodiments, the compensator defines two or more ports spaced laterally and/or axially.
- (21) The top wall of the compensator optionally defines a dovetail slot for attachment of a front

sight. In one such embodiment, the front sight is effectively fixed to the barrel by being attached to the compensator and therefore does not cycle rearward and forward with the slide. When the front sight is attached to the compensator, rather than the slide, the front sight can be positioned further forward, resulting in an increased sight radius compared to a sight attached to a slide that terminates at the end of the barrel.

Overview

(22) Existing handgun compensators can be threaded onto the threaded end of a handgun barrel. Despite tightening the compensator during installation, a combination of recoil forces, vibration, and thermal expansion cycles can loosen the engagement between the compensator and the barrel, resulting in rotation or loss of the compensator. When the front sight is mounted to the compensator, even slight rotation of the compensator can result in changes in the sight alignment that result in the shooter missing the target. Accordingly, it would be desirable to improve mounting techniques for a compensator for a handgun. Despite updates and development to handgun compensators, numerous non-trivial challenges remain.

(23) To address these needs and others, the present disclosure is directed to a handgun compensator that utilizes a combination of threaded engagement and fasteners, such as a screw or taper pin, to prevent rotation of the compensator. Numerous variations and embodiments will be apparent in light of the present disclosure.

Example Embodiments

(24) FIGS. **1-4** illustrate a handgun compensator **100** in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **1** is a front perspective view, FIG. **2** is a front view, FIG. **3** is a side view, and FIG. **4** is a perspective view showing a longitudinal section. These figures are discussed concurrently below.

(25) The compensator **100** has an upper portion **110** that is configured to install over the distal end of a handgun barrel. The upper portion **110** is generally configured to have the same profile as the handgun slide, such as appearing as an extension of the slide. In one such embodiment, the upper portion of the compensator mimics the handgun slide by having a geometry and other features consistent with those of the handgun slide. In one example, the upper portion has a top wall **112**, side walls **114**, **116** depending downward from the top wall, and a bottom wall **118**. The upper portion **110** can have a cuboid shape, such as a rectangular, trapezoidal, or oval cross-sectional shape, for example. A distal wall **120** connects to the other walls **112**, **114**, **116**, **118** and defines the distal end of the compensator **100** as well as an open region at the end of the barrel that directs a portion of propellant gases through a port in the top wall.

(26) In the example of FIGS. **1-4**, each of side walls **114**, **116** includes a substantially vertical section **114a**, **116a** and a sloped section **114b**, **116b** that slopes linearly downward and outward from the top wall **112** to the respective vertical section **114a**, **116a**. As shown, the upper portion **110** is configured to simulate an extension of the handgun slide of the handgun with which the compensator **100** is intended to be used. However, having the same or similar appearance as the handgun slide is not required; more generally, any one or more of the walls of the upper portion can have a planar geometry, an arcuate geometry, a folded geometry (e.g., having multiple planar sections), a complex geometry (e.g., faceted), or a combination of these features.

(27) The top wall **112** includes a generally planar portion **112a** that extends along the bore axis **10**. In some embodiments, the top wall **112** may also include a sloped portion **112b** that extends downward and forward from the planar portion **112a** to the distal wall **120**. In some embodiments, the sloped portion **112b** of the top wall **112** joins the planar portion **112a** at or in front of the end of the handgun's barrel. When present, the sloped portion **112b** can define an angle β with the bore axis **10** from 5 to 45°, including 10-35°, 10-20°, 15-30°, 20-30°, or about 20°, for example.

(28) In this example, the sloped portion **112b** defines one or more ports **140** positioned and configured to vent a portion of propellant gases from the barrel. In the example of FIGS. **1-4**, the sloped portion **112b** defines a single port **140** that extends laterally between (and substantially

extending to) the sloped sections **114b**, **116b** of side walls **114**, **116**. Note that port **140** has a width that is greater than the diameter of a projectile opening **130** in the distal wall **120** and that is also greater than the diameter of the barrel opening **132** located proximally of the projectile opening **130** in an intermediate wall **121**. In other embodiments, the port can have a size or diameter that is smaller than the projectile opening **130**. For example, the port **140** can be one or more bores formed in the top of the compensator **100**.

(29) Between the barrel opening **132** and the projectile opening **130** the compensator **100** defines an open volume **142** positioned axially between the distal wall **120** and the intermediate wall **121**, and positioned laterally between side walls **114**, **116**. As can be seen, for example, in FIGS. **1** and **4**, the volume **142** permits gas expansion laterally and vertically prior to exiting through the projectile opening **130** and port **140**.

(30) The compensator **100** defines one or more fastener openings **126**, each configured and positioned for a taper pin or other fastener to be installed. Part of the fastener opening **126** can be threaded in some embodiments. In one example, the fastener is a taper pin, where the taper pin engages an outer surface of the barrel, as discussed in more detail below. In one embodiment, the top wall **112** defines two fastener openings **126** on opposite sides of the barrel, each of which is positioned so that a fastener installed through the respective fastener opening **126** engages the outer surface of the barrel, such as a flat or recess. As shown in FIG. **4**, for example, each fastener opening **126** intersects the respective side wall **114**, **116** along an inside of the compensator **100**. As such, each side wall **114**, **116** defines a pocket **126a** to receive part (e.g., a shaft) of the taper pin. When installed, the taper pin can engage the barrel and the sidewall **114/116** along the pocket **126a** to result in a mechanical stop that prevents rotation of the compensator on the barrel. The fastener opening(s) **126** can be positioned axially so that each taper pin **176**, when installed, alternately or additionally creates a binding condition with the threads **133** in the barrel opening **132**. For example, as the fastener is installed, it forces the compensator **100** to shift slightly axially to bind the threads. At the same time, the fastener binds between the barrel and pocket **126a**, fixing the compensator **100** to the barrel and preventing rotation.

(31) In this example, each fastener opening **126** extends vertically through the top wall **112** (e.g., perpendicular to the bore axis **10**) when the bore axis **10** is horizontal. In other embodiments, the fastener opening(s) **126** can extend at some other angle through the top wall **112** (or other wall). For example, fastener openings **126** can extend through the top wall **112** in a downward and laterally outward direction. In yet other embodiments, each fastener opening **126** extends laterally through one of the side walls **114/116**. Numerous variations and embodiments will be apparent in light of the present disclosure.

(32) In some embodiments, part of the fastener opening **126** is threaded. For example, the portion of the fastener opening **126** through the top wall **112** is threaded, while the remainder of the fastener opening **126** is configured to receive a smooth taper or straight shaft on the fastener **176**. In another example, the bottom of the pocket **126a** is threaded, such as for a fastener having a threaded tip.

(33) Optionally, the top wall **112** defines a dovetail slot **122** extending crosswise to the bore axis **10**, the dovetail slot **122** configured for attachment of a front sight **124**. The top wall **112** optionally can further define one or more threaded bores (not shown) for securing the front sight in the dovetail slot **122**.

(34) The projectile opening **130** is the distal opening of a through-bore **136** that extends through the upper portion **110** along a bore axis **10**. The through-bore **136** is configured for passage of a projectile and propellant gases when the gun is fired. At least part of the through-bore **136** is sized to receive the distal end portion of the handgun barrel. Part of the through-bore **136** can include threads **133** for threadably engaging a threaded barrel. As shown in the sectional view of FIG. **4**, for example, the through-bore **136** includes projectile opening **130**, barrel opening **132** (threaded in this example), and one or more additional diameters **134** located proximally of the threaded barrel

opening **132**. In some embodiments, each additional diameter **134** is greater than the diameter of the barrel opening **132** and corresponds to a portion of the barrel of greater diameter. In other embodiments, the barrel opening **132** is a smooth bore configured for a slip fit over a smooth or threaded barrel.

(35) In some embodiments, the compensator **100** has a lower portion **160** attached to and positioned below the upper portion **110**. In some embodiments, the lower portion **160** simulates a spring box of the handgun slide, or an extension thereof, such as having a reduced width compared to the upper portion **110**. The lower portion **160** can be hollow in some embodiments.

(36) FIG. 5 is a rear perspective view showing a slide assembly **170** in a partially disassembled state, where the slide assembly **170** includes a compensator **100**, one or more fasteners **176**, a handgun slide **180**, and a threaded barrel **190**. When the barrel **190** is installed in the slide **180**, the distal end portion **192** of the barrel **190** extends beyond the end of the slide **180**. The distal end portion **192** includes a threaded portion **193** and region of greater diameter **195** behind the threaded portion **193**. Lateral sides of the distal end portion **192** define recesses or flats **194**. Each flat **194** is positioned behind the threaded portion **193** and is configured to engage a fastener **176**, such as a taper pin. In other embodiments, the flats **194** can be forward of the threaded portion **193**.

(37) The compensator **100** can be configured as discussed above with reference to FIGS. 1-4. As seen here, the compensator **100** includes fastener openings **126** and corresponding pockets **126a** along the inside of the compensator **100**. In this example, each fastener opening **126** is threaded through part of all of its length through the top wall **112**, so as to threadably engage a fastener **176** having a threaded head and having a smooth (non-threaded) shaft. The compensator **100** defines a threaded barrel opening **132** (not visible) that threadably engages the threaded portion **193** of the barrel **190**. After threading the compensator **100** onto the barrel **190**, fasteners **176** can be installed into fastener openings **126** to fix the rotational position of the compensator **100** by creating a mechanical stop between the barrel **190** and the compensator **100**.

(38) FIG. 6 illustrates a front perspective view of a distal end portion of a handgun slide **180** and a compensator **100** installed on the barrel **190**. Fasteners **176** are recessed into the top wall **112** of the compensator **100**. The distal end **190a** of the barrel **190** is substantially flush with the barrel opening **132** in the intermediate wall **121**. In this example, the compensator **100** has a geometry and appearance that is consistent with that of the handgun slide **180**, thereby simulating an extension of the slide **180**.

(39) FIG. 7 illustrates a perspective view of a fastener **176** and FIG. 8 illustrates a cross-sectional view of a fastener **176**, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. In these examples, the fastener **176** includes a head **177** and a shaft **178**. The head **177** is threaded. The shaft **178** is smooth (i.e., non-threaded) and includes a tapered section **178b** between a straight section **178a** and the head **177**. In this example, the shaft **178** further includes a straight section **178a** between the tapered section **178b** and the head **177**. The head **177** defines a recess **179** configured for turning and/or advancing the fastener **176** into the fastener opening **126**. The recess **179** can have a shape of a star, a hexagon, a plus, a slot, a triangle, a square, or other suitable geometry. In these examples, the tapered section **178b** is positioned to engage the barrel **190**. In other embodiments, the shaft **178** can be tapered along a majority portion or along its entire length. In yet other embodiments, the tip of the shaft **178** is threaded. For example, threads on the tip have an outer thread diameter that is equal to or smaller than the adjacent portion of the shaft **178**. As will be appreciated, a straight section of the fastener may deviate slightly from being perfectly cylindrical, but the straight section is straight within manufacturing tolerances. Numerous variations and embodiments will be apparent in light of the present disclosure.

(40) FIG. 9 illustrates a top and rear perspective view showing part of a slide assembly **170** with a compensator **100** attached to the handgun barrel **190** at the distal end of the slide **180**, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. 10 illustrates a top view showing a portion of the slide assembly **170** of FIG. 7. In this example, the compensator **100** is illustrated as

transparent to more clearly show the relative positions of the compensator **100**, fasteners **176**, and barrel **190**. The fasteners **176**, configured as taper pins with threaded heads in this example, extend vertically through the top wall **112** of the compensator **100** and engage respective flats **194** in the opposite sides of the distal end portion **192** of the barrel **190**. Note that the port **140** is positioned distally of the end of the barrel **190**. As shown in FIG. **10**, the vast majority of the port **140** is within a 60° angle α that intersects the crown of the barrel **190**.

(41) FIG. **11** illustrates a front perspective view of a slide assembly **170** in an assembled form, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **12** illustrates an exploded, side perspective view of the slide assembly **170** of FIG. **9**. The slide assembly **170** includes a handgun slide **180** for a semiautomatic handgun. The slide **180** includes a rear sight **181** and optionally includes a cover plate **182** and associated recess **183** for mounting optics. At the distal end of the slide **180** is a spring box or receptacle **184** for a recoil spring(s) **185** and a spring guide **186**.

(42) The barrel **190** is configured to be received in the slide **180** with the distal end portion **192** protruding beyond the distal end **187** of the slide **180**. As discussed above, the distal end portion **192** of the barrel **190** includes a threaded portion **193** with recesses **194** defined on opposite lateral sides of the barrel **190** for engaging respective taper pins **176**. A front sight **124** can be mounted to the compensator **100** via the dovetail slot **122**. As can be seen in FIG. **9**, the port **140** is positioned distally of the barrel **190**, which terminates at the intermediate wall **121**.

(43) FIGS. **13A** and **13B** illustrate top and rear perspective views of a compensator **100** installed on a firearm barrel **190** with fasteners **176** in an unlocked position. In this example, each fastener **176** is configured as a cam and has an eccentric cross-sectional shape. In this example, the head **177** of each fastener **176** is configured as a lever. In other embodiments, the head **177** of the fastener **176** defines a recess with a shape of a slot, a plus, a star, a square, a triangle, or other shape suitable for engagement by a tool as needed to rotate the fastener **176**.

(44) FIGS. **13C** and **13D** illustrate top and partial cross-sectional views showing the compensator **100**, fasteners **176**, and barrel **190** of FIGS. **13A** and **13B**, respectively. In FIG. **13C**, the fasteners are in the unlocked position and the smaller radius of the fastener **176** adjacent the barrel **190** results in the fastener **176** not engaging the barrel **190**. When the fasteners **176** are rotated to the locked position, such as shown in FIG. **13D**, the fasteners **176** engage the respective flat **194** on the sides of the barrel **190**. Note also that each fastener **176** also engages the compensator **100** along the fastener opening, resulting in a mechanical stop that prevents the compensator **100** from rotation about the barrel **190**.

(45) Referring now to FIG. **14**, a method **300** of installing a compensator onto a handgun barrel is illustrated. Method **300** may begin with providing **310** a barrel for a semiautomatic handgun, the barrel including a distal end portion with a threaded portion and defining flats on opposite sides of the distal end portion. Method also includes providing **320** a compensator defining a barrel opening coaxially aligned with a projectile opening, the barrel opening threaded for installation on the barrel. The compensator further defines fastener openings through a wall of the compensator and one or more ports positioned to vent a portion of propellant gases from the barrel upon firing the handgun. In one example, the fastener openings extend through the top wall of the compensator. In some embodiments, the fastener openings are threaded.

(46) Method **300** also includes providing **330** fasteners configured for installation in the fastener openings. In some embodiments, the fasteners are provided with a tapered portion. In some embodiments, the fasteners are provided with a head portion and a shaft portion, where the shaft portion can be straight or tapered along all or part of the shaft portion. In some embodiments, the head portion and/or a distal end portion of the shaft includes threads.

(47) Method **300** proceeds with threading **340** the compensator onto the distal end portion of the handgun barrel and installing **350** the fasteners into the fastener openings so that each of the fasteners contacts an outside of the barrel. In embodiments where the fasteners have threads and part of the fastener openings are threaded, installing **350** the fasteners includes rotating the

fasteners to threadably engage the threads on the fasteners with the threaded portion of the fastener openings. For example, when the head portion is threaded, the smooth shaft is inserted into the fastener opening, followed by using a tool (as needed) to advance and turn the fastener to thread the fastener head into the threaded portion of the fastener opening.

(48) In another embodiment where the fasteners are configured as a cam pin having an eccentric cross-sectional shape, each fastener is installed into the fastener opening in an unlocked position so that the fastener does not engage or minimally engages the barrel. After the fastener is installed, the fasteners can be rotated to a locked position so that each fastener engages the barrel, thereby locking the compensator to the barrel and preventing rotation of the compensator with respect to the barrel.

Further Example Embodiments

(49) The following examples pertain to further embodiments, from which numerous permutations and configurations will be apparent.

(50) Example 1 is a recoil compensator for a semiautomatic handgun. The compensator includes a compensator body extending along a bore axis and defining a through-opening along the bore axis. The compensator body has a top wall, a bottom wall, side walls extending downward from the top wall to the bottom wall, and a distal wall connected to the top wall, the bottom wall, and the side walls, where the distal wall defines a projectile opening centered on the bore axis. An intermediate wall spaced axially from the distal wall and defines a barrel opening. The compensator body defines an open region axially between the distal wall and the intermediate wall, and between the top wall, bottom wall, and side walls. The compensator defines one or more fastener openings, such as through a top wall, and also defines a port between the distal wall and the intermediate wall, where the port is configured to vent a portion of propellant gases from a handgun barrel when the recoil compensator is installed on the handgun barrel.

(51) Example 2 includes the subject matter of Example 1, where the through-opening includes a threaded barrel portion configured to mate with a threaded portion of the handgun barrel.

(52) Example 3 includes the subject matter of Examples 1 or 2, where the one or more fastener openings includes a first fastener opening on a first side of the bore axis and a second fastener opening on an opposite second side of the bore axis, each of the first and second fastener openings configured and positioned to receive a fastener that contacts an outside surface of the handgun barrel.

(53) Example 4 includes the subject matter of Example 3 and further comprises fasteners configured for installation in the fastener openings.

(54) Example 5 includes the subject matter of Example 4, where each fastener opening is threaded through the top wall and each fastener includes a threaded head portion.

(55) Example 6 includes the subject matter of Example 4, wherein the fastener has a shaft of eccentric cross-sectional shape.

(56) Example 7 includes the subject matter of Examples 4 or 5, where the fastener has a tapered shaft.

(57) Example 8 includes the subject matter of Examples 4 or 5, where each fastener includes a smooth shaft portion (i.e., non-threaded) that includes a tapered section.

(58) Example 9 includes the subject matter of Example 8, where the tapered section is spaced from the head portion by a straight section.

(59) Example 10 includes the subject matter of Example 9, where the straight section is a first straight section and the tapered section is between the first straight section and a second straight section.

(60) Example 11 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 3-10, where each of the first and second fastener openings defines a pocket on an inside of the compensator body, the pocket configured to receive a shaft portion of the fastener when the recoil compensator is installed on the handgun barrel.

(61) Example 12 includes the subject matter of Example 11, where at least part of the pocket is threaded.

(62) Example 13 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 1-12, where the top wall defines a dovetail slot extending crosswise to the bore axis.

(63) Example 14 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 1-13, where the top wall includes a first portion extending generally parallel to the bore axis and a second portion connected to and extending downward and forward from the first portion, wherein the second portion defines the port.

(64) Example 15 includes the subject matter of Example 14, where the second portion of the top wall defines an angle from 5-30° with respect to the bore axis.

(65) Example 16 includes the subject matter of Example 15, where the angle is from 15-25°.

(66) Example 17 includes the subject matter of Example 16, where the angle is about 20°.

(67) Example 18 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 1-17, where the compensator body is an upper portion, and the recoil compensator further comprises a lower portion connected to and positioned below the upper portion.

(68) Example 19 includes the subject matter of Example 18, where the lower portion simulates a recoil spring box of a handgun slide.

(69) Example 20 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 1-19, where the projectile opening is smaller than the barrel opening.

(70) Example 21 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 1-20 and further comprises a front sight mounted to the top wall of the compensator body.

(71) Example 22 includes the subject matter of Example 21, where the front sight is mounted to the compensator body using a dovetail slot.

(72) Example 23 is a slide assembly for a semiautomatic handgun, the slide assembly including a slide extending longitudinally to a distal end and a barrel extending along a bore axis and having a distal end portion including threads and flats or recesses in opposite sides of the barrel, where the barrel configured to be received in the slide with the distal end portion extending beyond the distal end of the slide. The slide assembly also includes fasteners and a recoil compensator defining a through opening along a central axis, where the through opening includes a threaded portion configured to threadably engage the threads on the distal end portion of the barrel. The recoil compensator also defines fastener openings each corresponding to one of the flats or recesses in the opposite sides of the barrel and configured to receive one of the fasteners. The compensator further defines a port in a top wall. When the recoil compensator is installed on the barrel, a proximal end portion of the compensator is adjacent the distal end of the slide, the central axis is substantially coincident with the bore axis, the threaded portion engages the threads on the barrel with a distal end of the barrel positioned proximally of the port, and the fasteners are received in respective fastener openings and engage respective recesses or flats on opposite sides of the barrel. When the recoil compensator is installed on the barrel, the port is configured to vent a portion of propellant gases from the barrel upon firing the handgun.

(73) Example 24 includes the subject matter of Example 23, wherein the recoil compensator has a compensator body including a top wall, a bottom wall, side walls extending downward from the top wall to the bottom wall, and a distal wall connected to the top wall, the bottom wall, and the side walls, where the distal wall defines the projectile opening. An intermediate wall is positioned proximally of and spaced axially from the distal wall, the intermediate wall defining the barrel opening. The compensator body defines an open region axially between the distal wall and the intermediate wall, and between the top wall, bottom wall, and side walls. The top wall defines the fastener openings and the port.

(74) Example 25 includes the subject matter of Example 24, where the one or more fastener openings includes a first fastener opening on a first side of the bore axis and a second fastener opening on an opposite second side of the bore axis, each of the first and second fastener openings

configured and positioned to receive one of the fasteners in contact with an outside of the handgun barrel.

(75) Example 26 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 23-25, wherein the fasteners have a shaft of eccentric cross-sectional shape.

(76) Example 27 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 23-25, where a portion of individual fastener openings is threaded and individual fasteners include threads.

(77) Example 28 includes the subject matter of Example 27, where the threads are on a head portion of each fastener.

(78) Example 29 includes the subject matter of Example 27, where the threads are on an end portion of each fastener.

(79) Example 30 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 23-29, where each of the fasteners has a tapered shaft.

(80) Example 31 includes the subject matter of Example 23-29, where the fasteners include a smooth shaft portion that includes a tapered section.

(81) Example 32 includes the subject matter of Example 31, where the tapered section is spaced from the head portion by a straight section.

(82) Example 33 includes the subject matter of Example 31, where the straight section is a first straight section and the tapered section is between the first straight section and a second straight section.

(83) Example 33 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 23-33, where each of the fastener openings defines a pocket on an inside of the compensator body, the pocket configured to receive a portion of the fastener when the recoil compensator is installed on the handgun barrel.

(84) Example 35 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 23-34, where the top wall of the compensator defines a dovetail slot extending crosswise to the bore axis.

(85) Example 36 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 23-35, wherein the top wall includes a first portion extending generally parallel to the bore axis and a second portion connected to and extending downward and forward from the first portion, wherein the second portion defines the port.

(86) Example 37 includes the subject matter of Example 36, where the second portion of the top wall defines an angle from 5-30° with respect to the bore axis.

(87) Example 38 includes the subject matter of Example 37, where the angle is from 15-25°.

(88) Example 39 includes the subject matter of Example 37, where the angle is about 20°.

(89) Example 40 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 23-39, where the compensator body is an upper portion and the recoil compensator further comprises a lower portion connected to and positioned below the upper portion.

(90) Example 41 includes the subject matter of Example 40, wherein the lower portion simulates a recoil spring box of the slide.

(91) Example 42 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 23-41, where the projectile opening is smaller than the barrel opening.

(92) Example 43 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 23-42 and further comprises a front sight mounted to the top wall of the compensator body.

(93) Example 44 is a semiautomatic handgun comprising the slide assembly of any one of Examples 23-43.

(94) Example 45 is a method of installing a compensator on a handgun barrel, the method comprising providing a barrel for a semiautomatic handgun, the barrel including a distal end portion with a threaded portion and defining flats or recesses on opposite sides of the distal end portion; providing a compensator defining a barrel opening coaxially aligned with a projectile opening, the barrel opening threaded for installation on the barrel, wherein the compensator further defines fastener openings through a wall of the compensator and one or more ports positioned to vent a portion of propellant gases from the barrel upon firing the handgun; providing fasteners

configured for installation in the fastener openings; threading the compensator onto the distal end portion of the handgun barrel; and installing fasteners into the fastener openings so that each of the fasteners contacts an outside of the barrel.

(95) Example 46 includes the subject matter of Example 45, where providing the fasteners includes providing fasteners having a tapered portion.

(96) Example 47 includes the subject matter of Example 46, where each of the fasteners includes a head portion and a shaft portion and the tapered portion is along the shaft portion.

(97) Example 48 includes the subject matter of Example 47, where the tapered portion is part of the shaft portion.

(98) Example 49 includes the subject matter of any one of Examples 45-48, where providing the fasteners includes providing fasteners having a threaded head portion, and wherein installing the fasteners includes engaging threads on the threaded head portion with threads in the fastener openings.

(99) Example 50 includes the subject matter of Examples 45 or 46, where providing the fasteners includes providing fasteners having a shaft of eccentric cross-sectional shape and installing the fasteners includes installing each fastener into the fastener opening in an unlocked rotational position, then rotating each fastener to a locked position in which the shaft engages the outside surface of the barrel.

(100) The foregoing description of example embodiments has been presented for the purposes of illustration and description. It is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the present disclosure to the precise forms disclosed. Many modifications and variations are possible in light of this disclosure. It is intended that the scope of the present disclosure be limited not by this detailed description, but rather by the claims appended hereto. Future-filed applications claiming priority to this application may claim the disclosed subject matter in a different manner and generally may include any set of one or more limitations as variously disclosed or otherwise demonstrated herein.

Claims

1. A recoil compensator for a semiautomatic handgun, comprising: a compensator body extending along a bore axis and defining a through-opening along the bore axis, the compensator body including a top wall; a bottom wall; side walls extending downward from the top wall to the bottom wall; a distal wall connected to the top wall, the bottom wall, and the side walls, the distal wall defining a projectile opening centered on the bore axis; and an intermediate wall spaced axially from the distal wall, the intermediate wall defining a barrel opening; wherein the compensator body defines an open region axially between the distal wall and the intermediate wall, and between the top wall, bottom wall, and side walls; wherein the top wall defines one or more fastener openings and defines a port between the distal wall and the intermediate wall, the port configured to vent a portion of propellant gases from a handgun barrel when the recoil compensator is installed on the handgun barrel; and wherein the bottom wall is closed from the intermediate wall to the distal wall.
2. The recoil compensator of claim 1, wherein the through-opening includes a threaded portion configured to threadably engage a threaded portion of the handgun barrel.
3. The recoil compensator of claim 1, wherein the one or more fastener openings includes a first fastener opening on a first side of the bore axis and a second fastener opening on an opposite second side of the bore axis, each of the first and second fastener openings configured and positioned to receive a fastener that contacts an outside surface of the handgun barrel.
4. The recoil compensator of claim 3, wherein each of the first and second fastener openings defines a pocket on an inside of the compensator body, the pocket configured to receive a shaft portion of the fastener when the recoil compensator is installed on the handgun barrel.
5. The recoil compensator of claim 4, wherein at least part of the pocket is threaded.
6. The recoil compensator of claim 1, further comprising fasteners configured for installation in the

one or more fastener openings, wherein each fastener opening is threaded through the top wall and each fastener includes a threaded head portion.

7. The recoil compensator of claim 1, further comprising fasteners configured for installation in the fastener openings, wherein each fastener includes a smooth shaft portion that includes a tapered section.

8. The recoil compensator of claim 7, wherein the tapered section is spaced from the head portion by a straight section.

9. The recoil compensator of claim 8, wherein the straight section is a first straight section and the tapered section is between the first straight section and a second straight section.

10. The recoil compensator of claim 1, wherein the top wall includes a first portion extending generally parallel to the bore axis and a second portion connected to and extending downward and forward from the first portion at an angle from 5-30° with respect to the bore axis, wherein the second portion defines the port.

11. The recoil compensator of claim 1, wherein the compensator body is an upper portion, the recoil compensator further comprising a lower portion connected to and positioned below the upper portion, wherein the lower portion simulates a recoil spring box of a handgun slide.

12. The recoil compensator of claim 1, wherein the projectile opening is smaller than the barrel opening.

13. The recoil compensator of claim 1, further comprising a front sight mounted to the top wall of the compensator body.

14. A slide assembly for a semiautomatic handgun, comprising: a slide extending longitudinally to a distal end; a barrel extending along a bore axis and having a distal end portion including threads and flats or recesses in opposite sides of the barrel, the barrel configured to be received in the slide with the distal end portion extending beyond the distal end of the slide; fasteners; and a recoil compensator defining a through opening along a central axis, the through opening including a threaded portion configured to threadably engage the threads on the distal end portion of the barrel, the recoil compensator further defining fastener openings each corresponding to one of the flats or recesses in opposite sides of the barrel and configured to receive one of the fasteners, and further defining a port in a top wall; wherein when the recoil compensator is installed on the barrel, a proximal end portion of the compensator is adjacent the distal end of the slide, the central axis is substantially coincident with the bore axis, the threaded portion threadably engages the threads on the barrel with a distal end of the barrel positioned proximally of the port, and the fasteners are received in respective fastener openings and engage respective flats or recesses on opposite sides of the barrel; and wherein when the recoil compensator is installed on the barrel, the port is configured to vent a portion of propellant gases from the barrel upon firing the handgun.

15. The slide assembly of claim 14, wherein the recoil compensator comprises: a compensator body including a top wall; a bottom wall; side walls extending downward from the top wall to the bottom wall; a distal wall connected to the top wall, the bottom wall, and the side walls, the distal wall defining the projectile opening; and an intermediate wall positioned proximally of and spaced axially from the distal wall, the intermediate wall defining the barrel opening; wherein the compensator body defines an open region axially between the distal wall and the intermediate wall, and between the top wall, bottom wall, and side walls; and wherein the top wall defines the fastener openings and the port.

16. The slide assembly of claim 14, wherein each of the fastener openings defines a pocket on an inside of the compensator body, the pocket configured to receive a portion of the fastener when the recoil compensator is installed on the handgun barrel.

17. The slide assembly of claim 14, wherein the top wall includes a first portion extending generally parallel to the bore axis and a second portion connected to and extending downward and forward from the first portion at an angle from 5-30° with respect to the bore axis, wherein the second portion defines the port.

18. The slide assembly of claim 14, wherein the compensator body is an upper portion, the recoil compensator further comprising a lower portion connected to and positioned below the upper portion, wherein the lower portion simulates a recoil spring box of the slide.

19. The slide assembly of claim 14, wherein the projectile opening is smaller than the barrel opening.

20. A method of installing a compensator on a handgun barrel, the method comprising: providing a barrel for a semiautomatic handgun, the barrel including a distal end portion with a threaded portion and defining flats or recesses on opposite sides of the distal end portion; providing a compensator defining a barrel opening coaxially aligned with a projectile opening, the barrel opening being threaded for installation on the barrel; wherein the compensator further defines fastener openings through a wall of the compensator and one or more ports positioned to vent a portion of propellant gases from the barrel upon firing the handgun; providing fasteners configured for installation in the fastener openings; threading the compensator onto the distal end portion of the handgun barrel; and installing fasteners into the fastener openings so that each of the fasteners contacts an outside of the barrel along one of the corresponding flats or recesses.

21. The method of claim 20, wherein providing the fasteners includes providing fasteners having a head portion and a shaft portion, wherein at least part of the shaft portion is tapered.

22. The method of claim 20, wherein providing the fasteners includes providing fasteners having a threaded head portion, and wherein installing the fasteners includes engaging threads on the threaded head portion with threads in the fastener openings.
